

Unsure of what to do, Zeus went to the Titan Prometheus, who had a reputation for being smart. "Please help me, Prometheus," Zeus begged, "I can't stand this pain." Prometheus realized what was going on at once, and he fetched a heavy metal ax.

*Without warning, Prometheus smacked Zeus across the forehead with the ax.*

Although the blow did not kill Zeus, for he was immortal, a crack opened in his head and out burst the goddess Athena. She was already grown and dressed in full armor.

Athena was the child that Metis had been carrying all along. Zeus was relieved to see that she was a woman, and not the son Gaia said would overthrow him. In fact, from that day on, Athena was always her father's favorite, because he saw himself as having given birth to her alone. He chose to ignore the small detail that he had swallowed her mother.

